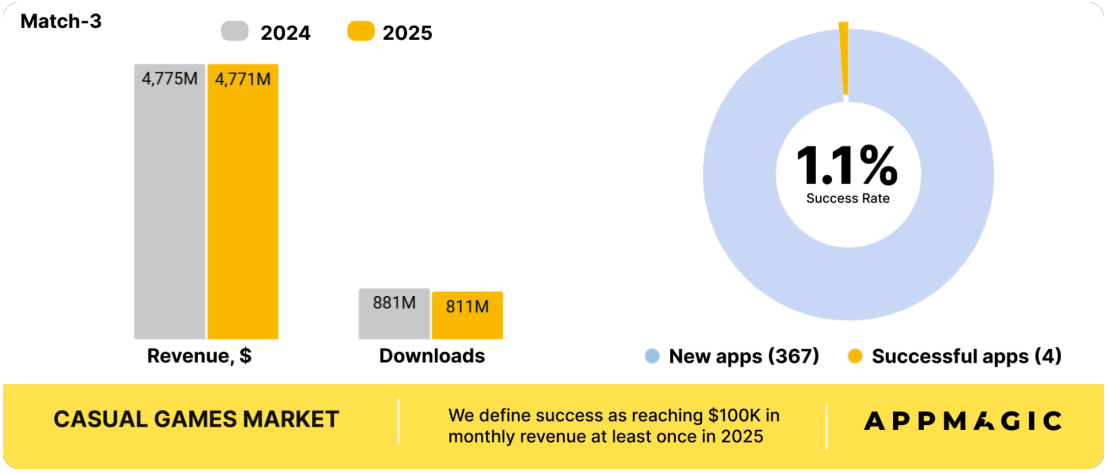
SD1: Match-3 Market Concentration and Dream Games' Revenue Performance in 2025

Original title: Casual Games Report 2025: Finding Growth in a Flat Market
Publisher: AppMagic
Author: Andrei Zubov and Lera Kalashnikova
Publication date: 19 February 2026
Source URL: https://appmagic.rocks/research/casual-report-2025
EXCERPT – original pages 5–9 of 32 reproduced unaltered (Puzzle market and Match-3 sections, incl. Dream Games data). […Original pages 1–4 omitted …]

Merge-2 continues to grow rapidly, increasingly drawing players from other major genres. However, growth comes with concentration. *Gossip Harbor* by Microfun has pushed its share to 33% of total Merge-2 revenue, and large publishers continue to strengthen their position through new releases. For smaller studios, competing here means keeping up with increasingly high player expectations set by top titles.

Against this backdrop, many developers are turning to the Hybridcasual market. It offers flexibility, strong UA potential, more room for experimentation, and lower entry barriers. Still, this window may not stay open for long, as clear leaders are already beginning to establish their prominence in this space.

Match-3: Keeping It Steady at $4.7B Per Year



Match-3 continues to be the main revenue engine of the Casual Puzzle market, generating more than 58% of its overall earnings. The segment brought in $4.8B in 2025, and despite this scale, revenue was essentially flat, **fluctuating within a mere 0.1% and thus signaling a mature and stable market**. Downloads declined by 8% as most leading titles in the segment reached saturation and shifted their focus from aggressive UA toward maximizing LTV.

As outlined in our H1 2025 report, around half of the segment's revenue was, at the time, concentrated in just two titles—*Royal Match* and *Candy Crush Saga*—and this hasn't changed. What's even more telling, the entire top 5 remains unchanged from last year, reinforcing how firmly established these leaders are. What stands out is that *Candy Crush Saga* was the only game on this chart to increase revenue, but it's still more than $300M behind the top

Looking at the broader top 10, **only two new titles entered the chart**: *Royal Kingdom* and *Matching Story*—one backed by *Dream Games*' proven strategy, while the other climbed steadily over the course of several years. These cases only underline just how high the entry barrier has become in Match-3.

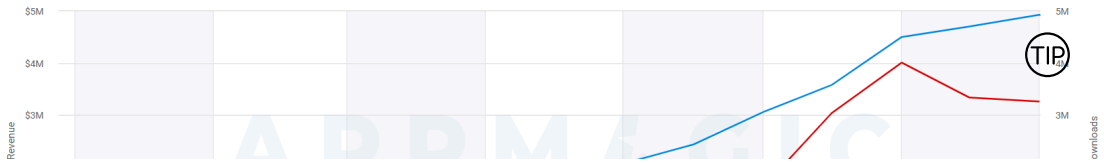
	Apps	Current revenue	Revenue growth %	Current downloads	Downloads growth %	First Release
	Games · Casual · Puzzle · Match-3	**$4 771 092 133**	-0,07%	**811 504 744**	-7,64%	
1	Royal Match Dream Games	$1 374 263 390	-1,16%	85 380 564	-26,36%	Jul 18, 2020
2	Candy Crush Saga King	$1 011 009 231	+3,14%	111 400 951	-3,03%	Oct 19, 2012
3	Gardenscapes Playrix	$396 407 424	-12,86%	50 532 286	-5,09%	Jun 04, 2016
4	Homescapes: Match 3 Games Playrix	$277 563 489	-13,46%	28 911 796	+7,66%	Jul 26, 2017
5	Fishdom Playrix	$254 446 684	-18,39%	27 386 109	-53,26%	Aug 12, 2013
19▲ 6	Royal Kingdom Dream Games	$246 026 471	+1 558,46%	83 057 473	+830,35%	Mar 20, 2023
7 1▼	Candy Crush Soda Saga King	$161 075 038	-19,37%	25 571 771	-21,06%	Jun 10, 2014
1▲ 8	开心消消乐® 乐元素	$119 404 008	+29,15%	14 577 927	-3,44%	Feb 27, 2014
2▲ 9	Matching Story - Puzzle Games VERTEX GAMES PTE. LTD.	$91 744 595	+39,09%	9 319 232	+55,91%	May 25, 2021
10 3▼	Project Makeover Magic Tavern, Inc.	$85 024 422	-27,64%	20 510 059	-61,97%	Nov 19, 2019

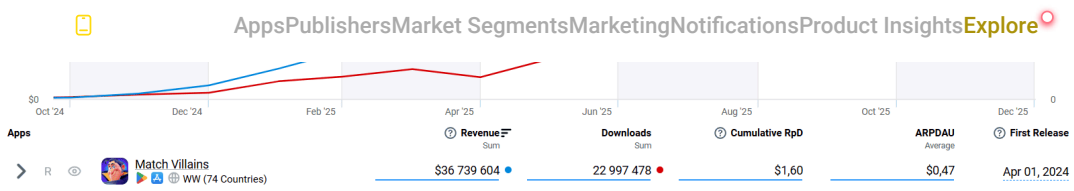
Period Comparison: top 10 Match-3 games in 2025

Once you look beyond the top rankings, the reality of the Match-3 market becomes clear: competition is fierce. In 2025, just 4 out of 367 newly launched titles managed to exceed $100K in monthly revenue at least once. These were *Squishmallows Match* (which dropped below $100K shortly after), *Family Farm Match*, *假日乐消消* (roughly translates as "Holiday Fun"), and *Puzzle SEVENTEEN* (based on the popular K-pop IP that clearly helped the title boost visibility in such a crowded market).

Keep in mind that $100K per month is a very low bar for a Match-3 game, yet most new projects fail to reach it. Polished core gameplay, diverse LiveOps, and well-tuned monetization are now the baseline expectations for the genre, set by leading titles with years of experience. That's why any fast climber, new or not, quickly draws industry attention.

One of the standout examples in 2025 was *Match Villains* by Good Job Games. Launched in November 2024, the game steadily gained traction throughout 2025 and **ranked 17th among the year's top-grossing Match-3 titles**, with over $36M in lifetime revenue.





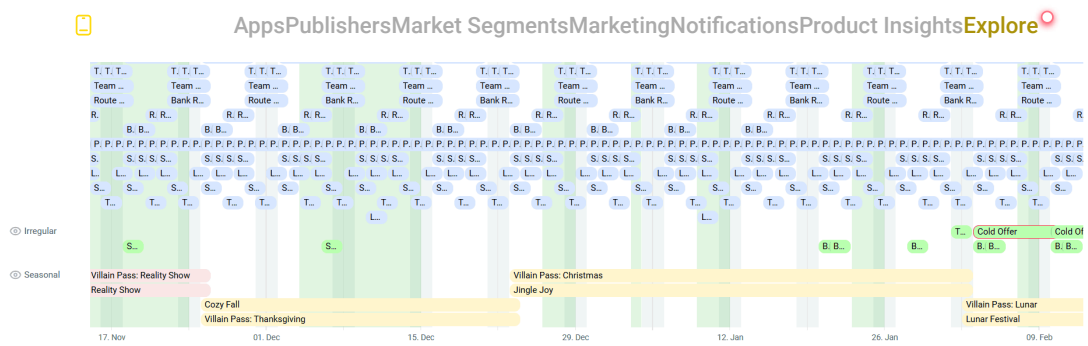
Match Villains' revenue & downloads

The title's still relatively young and actively scaling, using smart LiveOps as a core engagement driver. To keep up with market leaders, *Match Villains* constantly tests and launches fresh formats and mechanics. In the last 90 days alone, the team introduced two new event types:

- Icy Blocks: a milestone-based event built around a Tetris-like mechanic, designed to increase core gameplay engagement and session length. The event has already become part of the game's regular LiveOps rotation, and in February, the team even added the Cold Offer, a dedicated paid pass
- Shrink Inc.: a co-op event featuring Lucky Spins and reward milestones, also directly tied to core progression

Over the last year, the game has steadily expanded its LiveOps portfolio and increased event density, **moving from 26 monthly events in September to 33 by December**. The same test-and-learn mindset is visible in monetization: pricing was refined (for example, our Monetization Intelligence shows that the Big Catch bundle dropped from $4.99 to $0.99 in September), while new monetization layers such as chain offers and season passes were added.



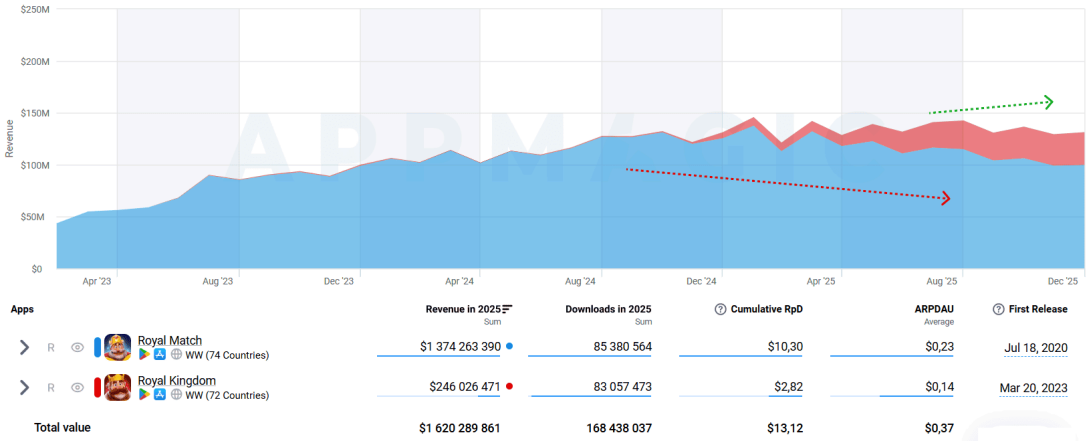


Match Villains' LiveOps & Updates Calendar

This mix of LiveOps depth and refined monetization, built onto a well-designed core, shows how much effort it now takes for a fresh title to break into the segment's top 20. Meaningful breakthroughs are only possible with ongoing investment into deeper systems that sustain retention and keep revenue flowing over time.

For smaller studios, matching the scale of top-grossing publishers remains extremely challenging. To put it in perspective, **Dream Games now holds more than 30% of the total Match-3 revenue** with just two titles.

Last year, the studio generated $1.6B, posting +15% YoY growth. And here's the plot twist: this growth was driven not by its flagship title but by… *Royal Kingdom*. Even though it still lags behind its predecessor in total revenue share, its rapid growth more than offset *Royal Match*'s –1% YoY drop, allowing the studio to continue scaling and avoid stagnation.



Dream Games' revenue dashboard

Built on the same core design philosophy, *Royal Match* and *Royal Kingdom* naturally share many monetization traits. A closer look through our **IAP Revenue Distribution tool** reveals several patterns:

driving 33% of first purchases in *Royal Match* and 37% in *Royal Kingdom*.

- The $6.99 "boosters + coins" bundle is the second most common first IAP, chosen in 15% of cases in *Royal Match* and 11% in *Royal Kingdom*.
- The most commonly purchased IAPs are priced between $1.99 and $9.99 and include currency and booster bundles alongside the season pass.
- In terms of revenue share, the $6.99 bundle generates the largest contribution in *Royal Match* (15%), while *Royal Kingdom's* top revenue driver is the $9.99 bundle (13%).



App Store In-App Purchases	Revenue Share Average	Quantity Share Average	1st Purchase Share Average	Price
mini coin package	9,9%	34,4%	34,88%	$1,99
royal favor	14,9%	14,6%	15,06%	$6,99
duke's treasure	6,0%	6,9%	7,02%	$5,99
prince's treasure	7,4%	5,2%	5,21%	$9,99
royal pass	5,5%	3,8%	3,87%	$9,99

Data from iPhone App Store, US APPMAGIC

App Store In-App Purchases	Revenue Share Average	Quantity Share Average	1st Purchase Share Average	Price
mini coin pack	10,1%	36,1%	37,21%	$1,99
king's favor	10,1%	10,9%	10,94%	$6,99
splendid pouch	13,3%	9,7%	9,72%	$9,99
noble pack	7,7%	9,0%	9,36%	$5,99
kingdom pass	7,4%	5,3%	5,45%	$9,99

Data from iPhone App Store, US APPMAGIC

IAP revenue distribution: top 5 offers by quantity share in Royal Match vs Royal Kingdom

This data shows how the leading Match-3 studio structures its monetization and offers a practical reference point for anyone entering or competing in the genre. To see exactly which offers power your competitors' revenue, book a demo and try AppMagic's IAP Revenue Distribution analytics yourself.

To request demo access to AppMagic's IAP Revenue Distribution tool, please click below to fill out the form.

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These overlaps reflect not only similar gameplay but also genre-specific player behavior and Dream Games' consistent execution of a proven monetization strategy. The results speak for themselves as *Royal Kingdom* quickly secured a spot in the top 10. While the revenue gap

[… Original pages 10–32 omitted …]

SD2: Royal Kingdom's $750m Revenue Milestone and Geographic Revenue Split

Original title: Royal Kingdom surpasses $750m with 42% of all revenue made in H1 2026
Publisher: PocketGamer.biz
Author: Aaron Astle
Publication date: 14 July 2026
Source URL: https://www.pocketgamer.biz/royal-kingdom-surpasses-750m-with-42-of-all-revenue-made-in-h1-2026/
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Royal Kingdom surpasses $750m with 42% of all revenue made in H1 2026

Dream Games' match-3 title has found its most lucrative audience in the US, following suit after Royal Match



By Aaron Astle | July 14, 2026

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DATE	TYPE	COMPANIES INVOLVED	KEY DATAPOINT
Jul 14, 2026	MILESTONE	• Dream Games	$750 million

Royal Kingdom reached $750 million in mobile earnings on July 3rd, 2026.

The title has outpaced Royal Match to the milestone.

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Royal Kingdom has surpassed $750 million in mobile player spending after a record first half of the year.

According to **AppMagic** estimates, **Dream Games'** match-3 puzzler reached the milestone on July 3rd, less than two years on from its global launch. Today, total spend sits at $766.1m.

Of that sum, $324.8m was earned in H1 2026 alone, equating to 42% of lifetime player spending. The title **launched worldwide in November 2024** and has seen considerable growth since, scaling from just $50m in its first six months globally.

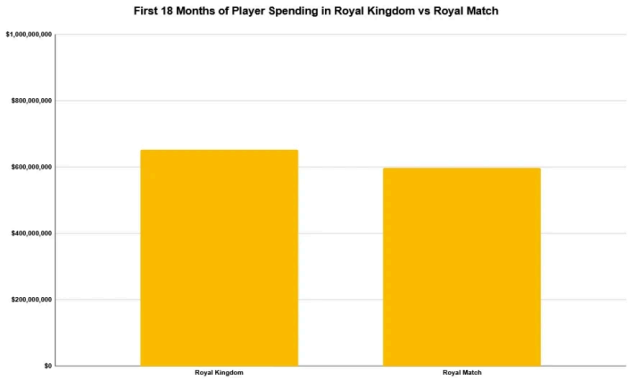
A royal rise

Royal Kingdom entered soft launch across the UK, Canada and other select regions in 2023, spending 19 months in this testing phase before going global.

Earnings grew steadily after its full release, with **the US taking the lead over the UK** in player spending. Today, the country accounts for 61% of global earnings while the UK has contributed just 7%, followed by Japan's 5%.

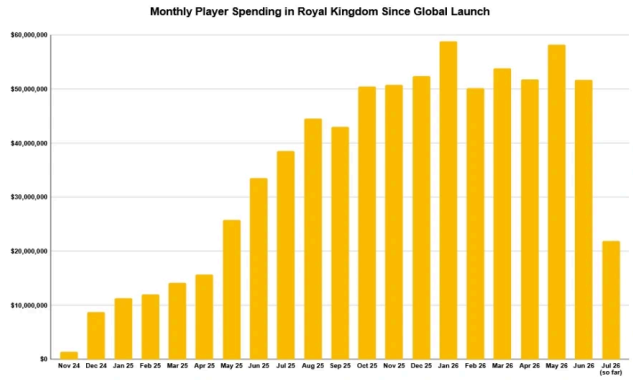
It's a similar distribution to Dream Games' earlier match-3 giant Royal Match, where the US leads with a 53% share of spending. Japan and the UK follow in second and third at 9% and 5%. Notably, Royal Kingdom is actually outperforming Dream Games' flagship when compared to its early earnings.

Of course, Royal Match still leads in lifetime revenue with more than $7 billion generated since 2021.



Between the major stores, 63% of Royal Kingdom's lifetime player spending has come from App Store users versus 37% from Google Play users. The game's total earnings may be even higher when including alternative app stores.

Across Google Play and the App Store, January 2026 marked the game's most lucrative month to date at $58.9m, up 421% year-over-year. Spending has fluctuated since but remained above $50m per month throughout the first half of 2026.



The rise is reflective of daily earnings dramatically increasing over time, rather than occasional successful spells. After a soft launch high of $71,000, Royal Kingdom's daily earnings between the major platforms grew to a 2024 peak of $353,000 on December 21st.

Player spending steadily increased towards $500,000 in daily revenue by March 2025 and snowballed to the game's first $1m day on May 18th that year.

Royal Kingdom's current daily earnings record is $2.7m on January 31st, 2026.

Read more about **Royal Kingdom** on our sister site, PocketGamer.com.

#Milestone #Revenue #Match-3 #Puzzle #Royal Kingdom

COMPANIES

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Royal Kingdom surpasses $100m after record month

Royal Kingdom surpasses $50m in player spending

Royal Kingdom surpasses $300m in first year, beating Royal Match

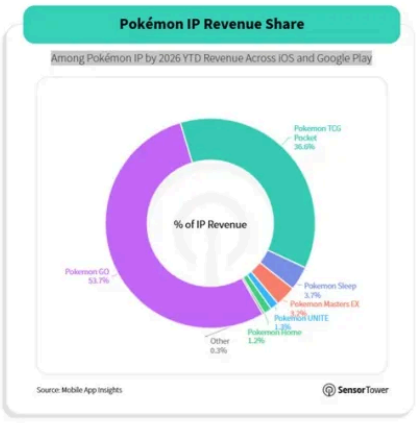
Royal Kingdom surpasses $20m in soft launch revenue with November 21st global release date set

Dream Games and Peak Games responsible for over 80% of Türkiye's games revenue

SD3: Q1 2026 Casual Game and Publisher Revenue Rankings

Original title: Data digest: Q1's top performers, milestones for Pokémon TCG Pocket, Heartopia, eFootball and plenty more
Publisher: Mobilegamer.biz
Author: Tom Ivan
Publication date: 15 April 2026
Source URL: https://mobilegamer.biz/data-digest-q1s-top-performers-milestones-for-pokemon-tcg-pocket-heartopia-efootball-and-plenty-more/

EXCERPT – original pages 4–8 of 19 reproduced unaltered (casual games and publisher Q1 revenue sections). […Original pages 1–3 omitted …]



Among all Pokémon titles on mobile, Pokémon Go accounts for 53.7% of total IAP revenue generated by the IP so far in 2026.

It leads the way ahead of Pokémon TCG Pocket (36.6%), with Pokémon Sleep (3.7%) a distant third.

Royal Kingdom tops casual games by Q1 revenue



Appmagic has published a list of the top 10 casual games by IAP revenue in Q1 2026.

Dream's puzzle game Royal Match retained the top spot, despite earnings falling 21% YoY to $312m. Downloads were also down 21% to 16m.

Scopely's Monopoly Go was another non-mover in second place, with revenue of $294m (-9% YoY) and 9m downloads (-8% YoY).

Microfun's Gossip Harbor: Merge & Story was up four places to third on the chart as revenue rose by 172% YoY and 6% QoQ to reach $270m. Downloads were up 74% YoY to 22m.

King's Candy Crush Saga was up next with $263m (-7% YoY) in earnings and 23m downloads (-20% YoY), ahead of Moon Active's Coin Master with $173m (-13% YoY) and 8m installs (-17% YoY).

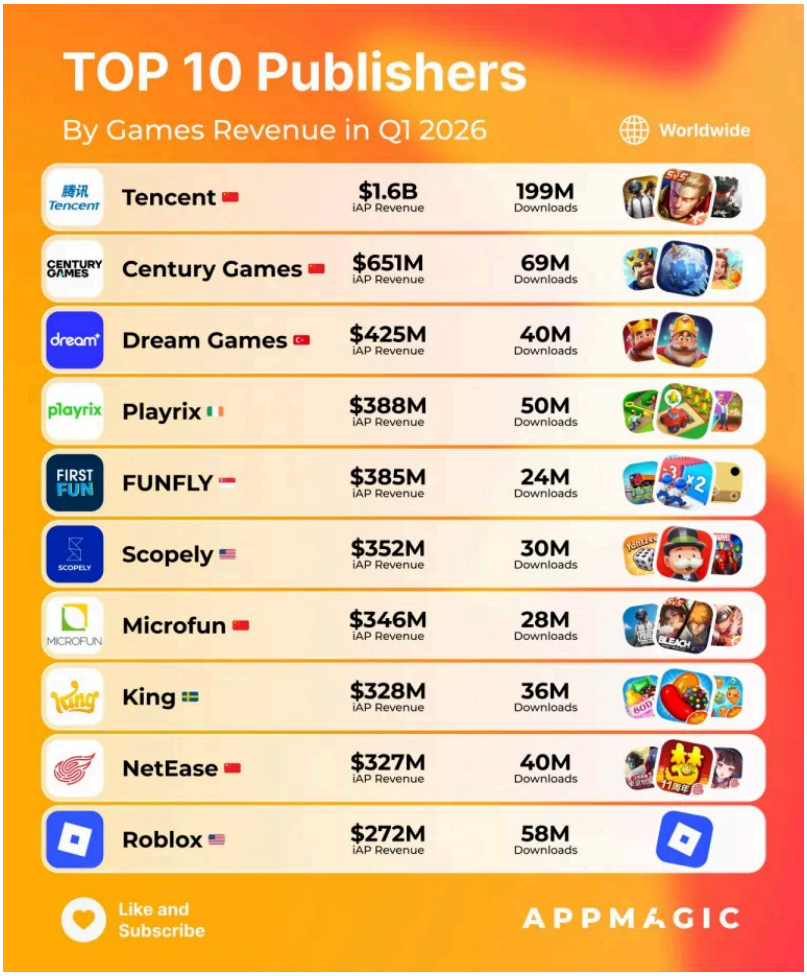
Heartopia tops 30m downloads



Life simulation game Heartopia has surpassed 30m downloads, according to its publisher XD Games.

The cosy multiplayer title officially launched on January 7, 2026, for iOS, Android and PC, and it was one of that month's most downloaded mobile games.

Tencent leads publishers by revenue in Q1



Appmagic's top 10 publishers by mobile games IAP revenue chart once again has Tencent as the clear frontrunner in Q1.

Driven by the return to growth of flagship titles like Honor of Kings and PUBG Mobile, it earned $1.6bn in the first three months of the year – up 15% QoQ and almost 2.5× that of its nearest competitor. Its games were downloaded 199m times.

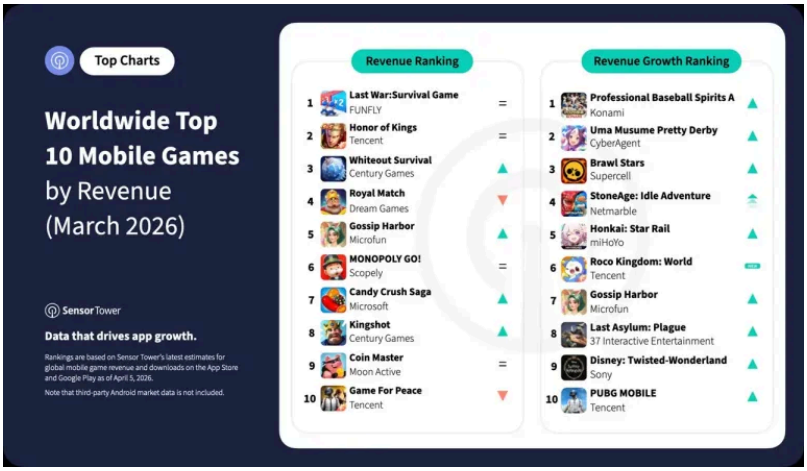
Fellow Chinese publisher Century Games held second place on the list with $651m in revenue, which was up 49% YoY, and almost stabilising QoQ. It saw downloads jump 20% QoQ and 77% YoY.

Türkiye's Dream Games earned $425m in Q1, which was relatively stable QoQ and YoY. Its downloads increased by 28% QoQ and 53% YoY, with Royal Kingdom installs 1.5x higher than Royal Match's in March.

Ireland's Playrix was in fourth place with revenue of $388m. Its portfolio of games, which include Township, Fishdom, Homescapes and Gardenscapes, racked up 50m downloads.

Singapore-based Funfly rounded off the top five with $385m in earnings. The Last War: Survival maker hit 24m downloads in Q1.

Mobile games spending rose to $6.7bn in March



Consumer spending on mobile games through the App Store and Google Play hit $6.7bn in March, according to Sensor Tower estimates.

Global spending was up 2% MoM, with the US accounting for 31% of total revenue, ahead of China (iOS only) at 15.4% and Japan at 12.1%.

Last War Survival retained the top spot on the revenue chart in March. Honor of Kings was also a non-mover in second place, while Whiteout Survival moved up to number three.

Global downloads increased 9% MoM to reach 3.8bn in March. India accounted for 616m downloads (16.6%), ahead of the US (7.2%) and Indonesia (6.8%).

Block Blast held the top spot as the month's most downloaded mobile game, while Free Fire moved up one place to second, swapping places with Roblox.

eFootball clears 1bn downloads

[… Original pages 9–19 omitted …]

SD4: Expert Views on Whether Royal Kingdom Will Complement or Cannibalise Royal Match

Original title: Will Royal Kingdom complement or cannibalise Royal Match? We asked the experts
Publisher: Mobilegamer.biz
Author: Neil Long
Publication date: 21 November 2024
Source URL: https://mobilegamer.biz/will-royal-kingdom-complement-or-cannibalise-royal-match-we-asked-the-experts/
FULL ARTICLE TEXT – original pages 1–4 of 15 reproduced unaltered. Pages 5–15 contain only website elements (related links, newsletter sign-up, footer) and are omitted.



Will Royal Kingdom complement or cannibalise Royal Match? We asked the experts

By Neil Long / 21st November 2024

Dream Games' Royal Kingdom goes live worldwide today after over 18 months in soft launch and a slight pivot.

The follow-up to Dream Games' monster hit Royal Match is another match 3 puzzler in the same 'Royal' universe, but this second title has a more competitive edge. Royal Kingdom's first iteration featured regular social PvP/Coin Master/Monopoly Go-style levels in which players used the puzzle board to attack friends' bases.

But Dream later removed this feature, and turned those 'attack' levels into PvE 'Kingdom' boss fights. It must have resonated better, because that's the version Dream Games has pushed live worldwide today.

With a shared universe and many other similarities between Royal Match and Royal Kingdom, Dream Games appears to be adopting Playrix's model of having several complementary titles in the market at the same time. But doesn't this also carry a risk of cannibalising Royal Match? We asked three product experts for their thoughts.



Laura Taranto, Tom Froud and Harshal Karshande offer their thoughts on Royal Kingdom.

Senior director of product at Big Fish Games and Deconstructor of Fun contributor Laura Taranto described Royal Kingdom's journey through soft launch as "a masterclass in development."

"The first wave of Royal Kingdom wanted to target a different player profile than Royal Match – maybe puzzle players with a slight inclination to midcore, maybe a more male-centric audience," she told us. "While the attack levels are new to casual puzzle/match-3 games, Dream seemed to take inspiration from Supercell's Clash Quest or even Zynga's Empires and Puzzles."

"Dream also added a Player Rank in V1, which unlocked new areas to decorate, layered on top of a decoration currency propelled by skill, then removed it in V2, changing the overall feel (and economy) of meta progression. And, more importantly, severed the tie between skill and progression."

Royal Kingdom | Official Trailer
Royal Kingdom

İzlemek için:

Taranto continued: "With the V2 changes, it appears they've backtracked on the midcore appeal – axing rank and skill incentivized progression – and leaned more into the novel Kingdom levels: V1 had these levels every 10 while the most recent version

changed this to every five. Maybe the broader appeal stuck without needing features like rank that might complicate the game."

"Will it cannibalise Royal Match? There will be some cannibalisation, the theme and game itself are similar, but Royal Kingdom has higher difficulty," Taranto added. "Royal Kingdom will likely reach a smaller more enthusiastic audience that will pay more. While I've been bullish on Royal Kingdom and more so on Dream since the beginning, I have trouble seeing this game dwarf Royal Match's success."

Game economy and design consultant Tom Froud isn't all that concerned about cannibalisation, and is confident that Dream Games can succeed in adopting the Playrix model.



From September: 'Dream Games' Royal Match has passed $3bn, says Appfigures'.

"Homescapes was better than Gardenscapes but they co-existed (and thrived) perfectly nicely," he told us. "With only one title, it's easier for people to drift out of the 'Royal' ecosystem and play Candy or a 'Scapes game. On a macro level it's less about cannibalisation more about creating a safety net for people that fall out of one of the games."

"The first version of Royal Kingdom just didn't reach as wide an audience as had been hoped so it makes sense for Dream to pivot to the above approach rather than create a slightly different offering that just doesn't resonate."

Froud adds: "Dream have made a lot of money, the cynic in me feels like it's a bit of a self-fulfilling prophecy. They can buy players and iterate as much as they want – and they're great at both those things – until both games are successful."



From August 2023: 'As Royal Match blazes past $1bn, can Dream Games repeat the trick with Royal Kingdom?'.

Rovio game design lead Harshal Karvande writes in this week's Naavik Digest that Royal Kingdom is a superior product to Royal Match, but Dream does also risk cannibalising its predecessor. "The puzzle audience has shrunk, so there's no way this launch won't have a material impact on Royal Match if Royal Kingdom scales, right?"

"This is a play straight from the Playrix playbook, which has locked Gardenscapes, Homescapes and Fishdom into the top 10 highest-grossing puzzle games since 2017."

"Royal Kingdom may not overtake its successful older brother as its growth will be cautious because of the risk of cannibalization," he added. "But with Royal Kingdom's global release, Dream is on the path to have two games locked in the top 10 highest-grossing games in the casual puzzle market for years to come."

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[… Original pages 5–15 (website elements only) omitted …]

SD5: CVC's Strategic Investment in Dream Games and the Company's $5bn Valuation

Original title: Turkish startup Dream Games secures strategic investment by CVC
Publisher: Daily Sabah (with agencies)
Author: Daily Sabah with agencies
Publication date: 4 May 2025 (last updated 4 May 2025, 4:43 PM)
Source URL: https://www.dailysabah.com/business/tech/turkish-startup-dream-games-secures-strategic-investment-by-cvc
FULL ARTICLE TEXT – original pages 1–3 of 4 reproduced unaltered. Page 4 contains only the website footer and is omitted.

ECONOMY

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Dream Games and Royal Match logos are seen on mobile screens, May 1, 2025. (AA Photo)

BY DAILY SABAH WITH AGENCIES MAY 04, 2025 1:45 PM

One of the prominent players in the Turkish startup scene, Istanbul-based Dream Games, announced recently that it secured an investment by European private equity firm CVC to support its next chapter of growth and continued global leadership in mobile games.

The transaction will provide liquidity to Dream Games' initial venture capital partners, who will exit after five years and initiate a strategic partnership with CVC as its new equity partner, CVC said on Thursday.

The Turkish mobile games developer is best known for high-grossing puzzle games **such as "Royal Match"** and "Royal Kingdom."

The transaction, which includes debt provided by funds managed by Blackstone and other investors, values Dream Games at around $5 billion, Reuters reported, citing a source with knowledge of the deal.

A Bloomberg report also said that the deal values Dream Games at $5 billion, which is a steep increase from its $2.75 billion valuation in 2022, according to a source familiar with the matter.

CVC will buy out Dream Games' initial venture capital partners and become its sole equity partner as part of the deal, which it said will boost the development of new games.

The transaction is subject to regulatory approvals and is expected to be completed in the third quarter of 2025, Dream Games' statement said.

"Their (CVC's) experience investing in category-leading companies and track record of supporting the long-term vision of founding teams make them ideal partners as we continue to enhance our global leadership," said Soner Aydemir, co-founder and CEO of Dream Games.

"We are incredibly proud of what our team has built so far, and we're excited to enter this next phase of growth with the support of our new investors," Aydemir said.

LAST UPDATE: MAY 04, 2025 4:43 PM

KEYWORDS

GAME INDUSTRY / STARTUPS / DREAM GAMES / INVESTMENT / EQUITY

Türkiye's native 'Batman' roams streets of capital Ankara

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